take anybody along, but I thought, ‘What the hell,’ and asked Tenielle to join me on the tour. And she said yes.

When partners want to come along on tour, it’s automatic if you’re married – your wife comes with you. If you’re not married, we refer to a sort of points system: if you’ve played long enough and have earned enough points, Cricket SA will fly your girlfriend over and pay for her accommodation. Fortunately I had accumulated more than enough points by that stage.

So Tenielle came over to Barbados, which obviously meant it was the end of her relationship with her boyfriend. I know the break-up was pretty messy for her … in a lot of ways. But man, I just couldn’t wait to see her. And we had a really great time. We went swimming in the ocean every morning – it was a real honeymoon situation. I was bladdy besotted. It was in the West Indies that I realised how much Tenielle meant to me, and I was like, ‘Hersch, you’re in your early thirties now. Maybe it’s time to make a proper go of it. This is a nice time of your life to get married. You’re so crazy about this woman, she must be The One.’

So I asked Tenielle to relocate to Cape Town so that she could move in with me. We lived in my house in Higgovale for a while, and then we got a place in Green Point. We did up the house together and lived there for about two years. Things were great most of the time, but even then I often felt a little tied down. Every time I used to come back from a tour, I knew that the days were gone when I could just go off and play golf with my friends or have a boys’ night out. I actually felt guilty every time I asked Tenielle if I could go out without her, and, understandably, she wasn’t happy about me wanting to have boys’ nights. She wanted to know why I didn’t want to spend all my time with her.

And she was right … Why did I not want to spend all my time with her? After all, hadn’t I been so in love with her in the West Indies?

Looking back now, I can see I just wasn’t ready for commitment. And I’m still not, which is why I’m not in a relationship now. I’d rather just spend time with my mates. Or if I want to do sweet bugger all, I can do that too. When I was with Tenielle, it was like I’d get itchy feet. I loved going out for supper and a movie with her, for example, but then, after a few hours, I’d be like, ‘Where’s the party? Where’s the party?’ I just couldn’t relax; I always wanted to be on the go. After a few nights at home I’d want to be out with my mates. And it wasn’t the promise of hooking up with